

# UPS Batteries

The future will bring a complete change in the battery segment. The smart batteries of the future will have onboard circuitry that will communicate with the PC and its charger and share information like number of time battery had been charged, its chemistry, voltage, packaging and so on. This will not only increase the life of the battery in future but also charge it faster.

## Facts

❑ The batteries in the UPS are Sealed Lead Acid (SLA) that is used in case of a power outage. If a battery is inactive for a long period of time a chemical reaction, known as sulfation (formation of lead sulphate crystal that stalls flow of current) occurs. This can damage battery plates and leave it useless.

❑ Surge suppresser is an inexpensive way of protection against surge and spikes that can destroy UPS circuit and PC as well. Connect your UPS in series with spike guard.

❑ Sealed Lead Acid batteries contain live electrical current

and can be extremely dangerous—never touch battery terminals directly or with metal objects!

❑ To prolong the battery life, it is advisable to charge and discharge the battery completely once a month—for this run the accessories of your PC such as your printers and speakers from your UPS till they stop and then again charge the battery.

❑ Most UPS use SLA batteries and over time they go dead leaving you just one option—to replace them.

❑ All SLA batteries have sulfuric acid and Lead, both these agents can lead to environmental pollution if discarded in the wrong way. Sulphuric acid is highly corrosive, whereas Lead is known to affect the nervous system in human beings.

## Do Remember

❑ Return your old battery to the vendor from whom you bought the UPS, they will recycle it in the most appropriate way. Please don't throw such batteries along with your garbage.

❑ Do not store these batteries in

## Buying Tips

✓ The backup time and the rating of the battery are directly proportional—larger the VA rating more time your PC will work on this battery during power cuts.

✓ Refer your UPS manual or check the manufactures site to find the battery rating your UPS supports—buy a battery with maximum possible rating which will give enough time to safely close documents and shut

down your computer.

✓ The time required for charging the battery—the charging time should be small, battery should get charged within 4-5 Hrs.

✓ When going to buy a battery the VA rating, Terminal type supported for your previous battery and dimension should be noted, which help in choosing the supported battery by your UPS.

## Ready Reckoner

|                                                                                     |                                                                          |
|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------|
|  | A replacement for your old battery that was powering one PC              |
| <b>You Need</b>                                                                     |                                                                          |
| <b>Look for</b>                                                                     | A battery with a rating of 500VA                                         |
|  | A battery for short time power backup of around 20 minutes atleast       |
| <b>You Need</b>                                                                     |                                                                          |
| <b>Look for</b>                                                                     | A battery with a rating above 600VA.                                     |
|  | A battery that can provide sufficient power to PC as well as peripherals |
| <b>You Need</b>                                                                     |                                                                          |
| <b>Look for</b>                                                                     | A battery with a rating above 1KVA                                       |



extreme hot conditions or incinerate them.

❑ When you buy a new battery make sure it was not stored for longer than six months.

❑ Do not short circuit the two poles of a battery, it cause severe internal damage to the battery.

❑ When a new battery is installed, give it enough time to charge to its full level before putting it on any sort of load. Also most vendors ask for three to four cycles of complete charging and rapid discharging of the battery before putting them on any load, such procedure gets internal chemistry going smoothly.

❑ One important point to remember about any batteries is never mix new and old batteries. This will lead to more power to be drawn from the new battery reducing its life.